

Arrows

This document focuses on **arrows** as they are presented in the Bible.

- Arrows are **weapons of destruction** and are often described as **deadly**. They are also referred to as “shafts” and are said to be **sharp, bright, and polished**. Sometimes, arrows are **poisoned**.

- A **quiver** is used to carry arrows. Arrows are **discharged from bows** or **engines** and can be used for **amusement, hunting, or war**. They are shot **with great force** and **their speed is immense**. The ancients also used arrows for **divination**.

- Arrows are used **illustratively** throughout the Bible. They can represent **Christ** or **the word of Christ**, **God’s judgement**, and **severe afflictions**; they can also symbolize **bitter words**, **slandorous tongues**, **false witnesses**, **the devices of the wicked**, **young children**, **lightnings**, **destruction of power**, and **the paralyzing power of God**.

Arrows

Deadly and destructive weapons.

Proverbs 26:18 As a mad man who casteth firebrands, arrows, and Death,
Called shafts.

Isaiah 49:2 And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he
hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;
Sharp.

Psalms 120:4 Sharp arrows of the mighty, with coals of juniper.

Isaiah 5:28 Whose arrows are sharp, and all their bows bent, their Horses' hoofs shall be
counted like flint, and their wheels like a whirlwind:
Bright and polished.

Isaiah 49:2 And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he
hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;

Jeremiah 51:11 Make bright the arrows; gather the shields: the LORD hath raised up the spirit
of the kings of the Medes: for his device is against Babylon, to destroy it; because it is the
Vengeance of the LORD, the Vengeance of his temple.

Sometimes poisoned.

Job 6:4 For the arrows of the Almighty are within me, the poison whereof drinketh up my
spirit: the terrors of God do set themselves in Array against me.

Carried in a quiver.

Genesis 27:3 Now therefore take, I pray thee, thy weapons, thy quiver and thy bow, and go out
to the field, and take me some venison;

Isaiah 49:2 And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he
hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;

Jeremiah 5:16 Their quiver is as an open sepulchre, they are all mighty men.

Lamentations 3:13 He hath caused the arrows of his quiver to enter into my reins.

DISCHARGED

From a bow.

Psalm 11:2 For, lo, the wicked bend their bow, they make ready their arrow upon the string, that they may privily shoot at the upright in heart.

Isaiah 7:24 With arrows and with bows shall men come thither; because all the land shall become briers and thorns.

From engines.

2 Chronicles 26:15 And he made in Jerusalem engines, invented by cunning men, to be on the towers and upon the Bulwarks, to shoot arrows and great stones withal. And his name spread far abroad; for he was marvellously helped, till he was strong.

At a mark for amusement.

1 Samuel 20:20-22 And I will shoot three arrows on the side thereof, as though I shot at a mark. 21 And, behold, I will send a lad, saying, Go, find out the arrows. If I expressly say unto the lad, Behold, the arrows are on this side of thee, take them; then come thou: for there is peace to thee, and no hurt; as the LORD liveth. 22 But if I say thus unto the young man, Behold, the arrows are beyond thee; go thy way: for the LORD hath sent thee away.

At the beasts of the earth.

Genesis 27:3 Now therefore take, I pray thee, thy weapons, thy quiver and thy bow, and go out to the field, and take me some venison;

Against enemies.

2 Kings 19:32 Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a bank against it.

Jeremiah 50:14 Put yourselves in Array against Babylon round about: all ye that bend the bow, shoot at her, spare no arrows: for she hath Sinned against the LORD.

With great force.

Numbers 24:8 God brought him forth out of Egypt; he hath as it were the strength of an

unicorn: he shall eat up the nations his enemies, and shall break their bones, and pierce them through with his arrows.

2 Kings 9:24 And Jehu drew a bow with his full strength, and smote Jehoram between his arms, and the arrow went out at his heart, and he sunk down in his chariot.

Fleetness of, alluded to.

Zechariah 9:14 And the LORD shall be seen over them, and his arrow shall go forth as the lightning: and the Lord GOD shall blow the trumpet, and shall go with whirlwinds of the south.

The ancients divined by.

Ezekiel 21:21 For the king of Babylon stood at the parting of the way, at the head of the two ways, to use divination: he made his arrows bright, he consulted with Images, he looked in the liver.

ILLUSTRATIVE

Of Christ.

Isaiah 49:2 And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;

Of the word of Christ.

Psalms 45:5 Thine arrows are sharp in the heart of the king's enemies; whereby the people fall under thee.

Of God's Judgment.

Deuteronomy 32:23-42 I will heap mischiefs upon them; I will spend mine arrows upon them.

24 They shall be burnt with hunger, and devoured with burning heat, and with bitter destruction: I will also send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the poison of serpents of the dust. 25 The sword without, and terror within, shall destroy both the young man and the virgin, the suckling also with the man of gray hairs. 26 I said, I would scatter them into corners, I would make the remembrance of them to cease from among men: ...

Psalms 7:13 He hath also prepared for him the instruments of Death; he ordaineth his arrows

against the persecutors.

Psalm 21:12 Therefore shalt thou make them turn their back, when thou shalt make ready thine arrows upon thy strings against the face of them.

Psalm 64:7 But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded.

Ezekiel 5:16 When I shall send upon them the evil arrows of famine, which shall be for their destruction, and which I will send to destroy you: and I will increase the famine upon you, and will break your staff of bread:

Of severe Afflictions.

Job 6:4 For the arrows of the Almighty are within me, the poison whereof drinketh up my spirit: the terrors of God do set themselves in Array against me.

Psalm 38:2 For thine arrows stick fast in me, and thy hand presseth me sore.

Of bitter words.

Psalm 64:3 Who whet their tongue like a sword, and bend their bows to shoot their arrows, even bitter words:

Of slanderous Tongues.

Jeremiah 9:8 Their tongue is as an arrow shot out; it speaketh deceit: one speaketh peaceably to his neighbour with his mouth, but in heart he layeth his wait.

Of false witnesses.

Proverbs 25:18 A man that beareth false Witness against his neighbour is a maul, and a sword, and a sharp arrow.

Of devices of the wicked.

Psalm 11:2 For, lo, the wicked bend their bow, they make ready their arrow upon the string, that they may privily shoot at the upright in heart.

Of young children.

Psalm 127:5 Happy is the man that hath his quiver full of them: they shall not be ashamed, but they shall speak with the enemies in the gate.

Of lightnings.

Psalm 77:17-18 The clouds poured out water: the skies sent out a sound: thine arrows also went abroad. 18 The voice of thy thunder was in the heaven: the lightnings lightened the world: the earth trembled and shook.

(Broken), of destruction of power.

Psalm 76:3 There brake he the arrows of the bow, the shield, and the sword, and the battle. Selah.

(Falling from the hand), of the paralyzing power.

Ezekiel 39:3 And I will smite thy bow out of thy left hand, and will cause thine arrows to fall out of thy right hand.